

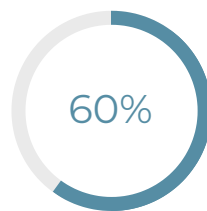
Your Resilience Assessment Report





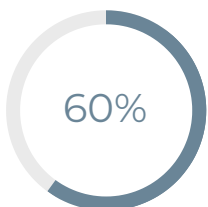
Assessment Report

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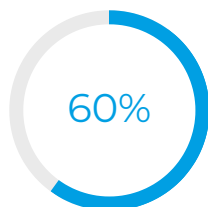


Your resilience level is - **Emerging**

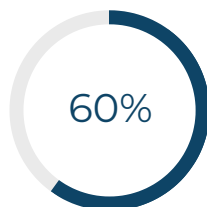
This score indicates that there are a number of areas which you should invest in to increase your level of personal resilience. Based on the answers you provided using the assessment tool, you have also been scored in each of the five key aspects of resilience. This assessment will explain what your scores mean and provide you with information in specific, highlighted areas.



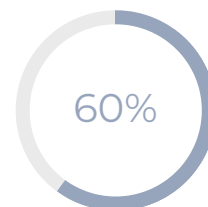
Mental
Strength



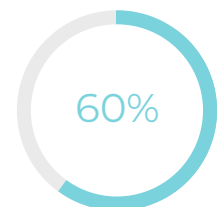
Purpose



Physical
Stamina



Emotional
Intelligence



Social Support

What is Resilience?

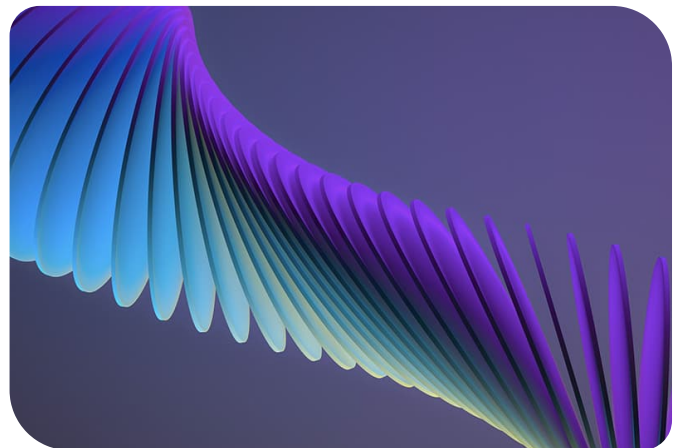
"It is not the strongest of the species that survives, nor the most intelligent; it is the one most adaptable to change."

- Charles Darwin

Throughout our lives we experience highs and lows on a daily basis, as well as more traumatic experiences which can have a more lasting impact – such as serious illness or the death of a family member. These changes affect people in different ways and bring with them a series of emotions and uncertainties which, in turn, govern our behaviour.

Resilience is defined as our ability to withstand or overcome adversity and successfully adapt to change and uncertainty. Examples of adversity may include serious illness, bereavement, an accident, stress at work or home, redundancy, financial problems or relationship issues. It is our capacity to recover quickly or 'bounce-back' from these difficulties and move forward positively that determines our resilience.

At birth we already have a degree of inbuilt resilience, but how we develop this further depends on life's circumstances and the way in which we respond. Ironically, we can only build our resilience when we experience setbacks and work through them. By learning new skills from previous challenges, we can be better prepared for what lies ahead and manage new or difficult situations more effectively.



Avoiding or running away from difficult situations, or being protected from problems, can be detrimental to our ability to cope with adversity. The good news is that we can actively develop our levels of resilience and thus be better prepared to manage difficult situations going forward.

Why Resilience is Important

Despite a general increase in the standard of living, statistics show that we are much less able to cope with the stresses of daily life. Globally, 5% of the population suffers from some form of depression and 13% suffer from some form of mental illness*

*Statistics from The World Health Organisation - 2019

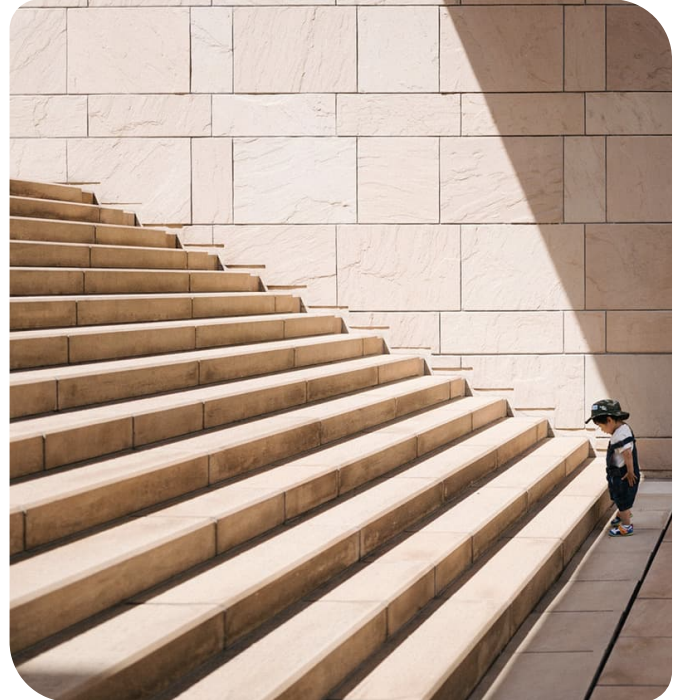
Younger people are generally more anxious and pessimistic than previous generations, with long-term employment, social media and climate change among their most commonly reported concerns. Around 1 in 5 children and adolescents suffer from a mental health disorder globally (WHO 2019).

In the workplace, personal stress levels are increasing due to higher workloads, lower budgets, a rapidly evolving market and changes in skill requirements; including the need to keep up with developments in technology and social media. Burnout is increasingly common, with increased levels of absence due to mental illness estimated to cost the global economy US\$1 trillion in productivity each year (WHO 2019).

There has been a 13% rise in mental health conditions and substance use disorders in the last decade.

Around 20% of the world's children and adolescents have a mental health condition.

*Statistics from The World Health Organisation - 2019



Whilst the long-term impact of the Covid-19 pandemic on public health will not be clear for some time, emerging data shows that the new or intensified stressors associated with the pandemic – including isolation, increased rates of domestic abuse, experiencing the loss of a loved one and job insecurity – have contributed to an increase in cases of depression and anxiety. Today, the global economic situation, energy crisis, international conflict and the impact of climate change are all contributing to people's concern about the future.

In a business environment, organisations need individuals, teams and leaders who can survive and grow in the face of these challenges. Going forward, organisations will need to provide a positive and flexible working environment with a culture supportive of change, adaptability and learning, along with a focus on relationships and networks.

What Makes a Person Resilient



We are all born with a certain level of inbuilt resilience, but how we develop this depends on our environment and how we respond to challenging situations.

Extensive research has been made into resilience and the characteristics which define a resilient person. There are many facets to this research, and from these we have distilled the most common characteristics possessed by highly resilient people:

Common characteristics of highly resilient people



Optimism, adaptability and persistence, with the ability to manage stress effectively.



A sense of purpose and meaning to their lives, with clear goals aligned to their personal values.



Taking care of themselves through healthy eating, regular exercise, restful sleep and a good work/life balance.



High levels of self-awareness, self-efficacy and self-esteem, with the ability to manage their emotions.



A highly supportive network of family, friends and colleagues – people they can trust and confide in when things get tough.



Your overall resilience level is - **EMERGING**

This score indicates that there are a number of areas which you should invest in to increase your level of personal resilience.

How Your Resilience Score is Calculated

In order to actively develop resilience, it is important to firstly understand your current level, then identify what you can do to strengthen it further.

Your score is calculated using the answers you provided whilst using the assessment tool. It gives an indication of your current level of resilience.

To find out how you scored in each of the five aspects of resilience, take a look at the ResilienceBuilder Model and advice pages which follow. Based on the answers you provided, you will receive guidance in areas which have been highlighted as benefiting from further development.



STRONG

This score indicates that you already have a strong level of resilience and can cope with adversity and manage stress effectively.



GROWING

This score indicates that you have a solid foundation on which to build your level of resilience, with some areas needing development.

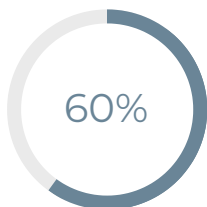


EMERGING

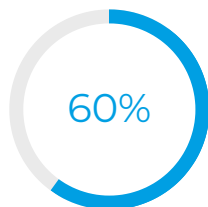
This score indicates that there are a number of areas which you should invest in to increase your level of personal resilience.

The ResilienceBuilder Model

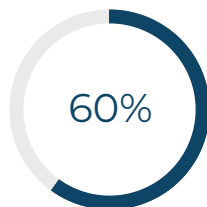
Developed using analysis of resilience scales and extensive experience in leading teams, the model includes the essential building blocks of resilience. Understanding each aspect will help you interpret your scores as we explore areas for improvement. You have been scored in each of the five key aspects of resilience, according to the ResilienceBuilder Model below.



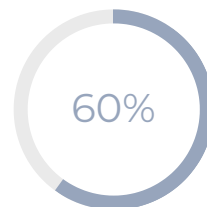
Mental Strength



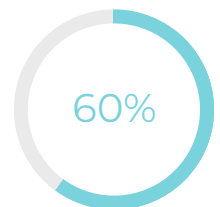
Purpose



Physical Stamina



Emotional Intelligence



Social Support

RESILIENCEBUILDER MODEL



MENTAL STRENGTH

Mental strength determines how well we cope with daily challenges, how adaptable we are when our situation changes and how we remain positive and optimistic under difficult circumstances.



PURPOSE

Having a clear sense of purpose and defined goals – in our personal lives and at work – is a key factor when it comes to building resilience. Knowing what we are trying to achieve helps us to bounce back and stay on course following setbacks, enabling us to remain true to ourselves and our values.



PHYSICAL STAMINA

Good exercise, nutrition and restorative sleep are critical to improving resilience. It doesn't require becoming an athlete, it simply requires being conscious of the components our body and mind need in order to support a positive lifestyle.



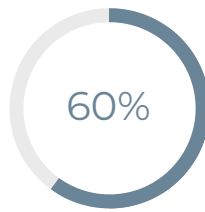
EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

High levels of Emotional Intelligence (EQ) enable us to recognise and manage our emotions, as well as the emotions of others. Emotions drive our behaviour and understanding how to manage them is crucial, particularly when dealing with pressure and stressful situations.



SOCIAL SUPPORT

Having a strong social support network of family, friends and colleagues is an essential aspect of resilience. When things get tough, having people you can confide in and turn to for support is vital, as is having a mentor to help you navigate through your journey.



Mental Strength

In the area of Mental Strength, your level of resilience is 60%. Mental strength determines how well we cope with daily challenges, how adaptable we are when our situation changes and how we remain positive and optimistic under difficult circumstances.

The outcome of the assessment tool indicates that you may benefit from focusing on the following areas:



Adapting to Change

We live in a fast-moving world where change is the constant all around us. The global financial crisis, climate change, the global pandemic, technological advancements and a rapidly changing business environment, all impact our lives and affect the way we live and work. During periods of change and uncertainty, we tend to focus on routine and the things we can control. However, existing practices and routines are often less effective in dealing with the new norms, so we need to be more flexible and adaptable when coping with change.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

In essence, we need to embrace change and be open to new ways of working and the opportunities which they could bring. When a major change occurs we typically go into a stage of shock followed by denial, continuing to operate in the same way as before. The sooner we can move through this stage and onto acceptance, the sooner we can embrace change and move forward positively.

Positivity and Optimism

Positivity is one of the key attributes that you will need in order for you to succeed in your endeavours, as long as it is balanced with a good sense of realism, to avoid the danger of blind optimism. Increasing your own level of optimism is possible and you can start by challenging your 'self-talk' – the voice in your head which constantly comments on your life and can tend to be negative. Turning those negative thoughts into positive feelings and actions will help you develop your optimistic and positive outlook on life. Changing your self-talk will make you feel more confident, calm and in control.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Write down your negative self-talk and re-write your thoughts in a more positive way. Argue with yourself, so when a thought such as, 'I am not good enough to do this,' comes into your head, ask yourself what evidence there is to support this. Following a difficult or challenging situation, think about what happened and reframe it in the context of, 'what new opportunities might this present going forward,' and, 'what can I learn from this.' Look for solutions, not problems.

Perseverance

Perseverance is the continued effort to achieve something despite difficulties, failure or opposition and is identified as a key characteristic in resilient people. However, simply trying harder or working longer hours in order to tackle a particular problem isn't always the answer and may not result in a better outcome. Learning from past failures and a change of direction are often needed to move forward.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

When faced with a challenge, do not simply work harder or longer in order to overcome it. The chances are you won't succeed, but coming at the problem from a different angle could be the answer. Remember that flexibility and adaptability are invaluable components of perseverance, as well as determination.

Perfectionism

Letting go of small things can be a major challenge if you are a perfectionist. Working to a high level of expectation and standard all of the time can cause significant stress, but changing behaviour can be extremely difficult to achieve.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Find the right balance between delivering high-quality work and delivering on your deadlines. Try working to a level of 90% rather than the 110% that you usually strive for and see if colleagues or your manager notice the difference. Make adjustments accordingly.

Prioritisation

As workload increases, pressure builds as we try to juggle multiple activities at once. We tend to focus on the easier tasks first, or the tasks that we enjoy doing, leaving the more difficult or less interesting tasks until another time. We also have a tendency to prioritise based on what is urgent rather than what is important which can mean we overlook or don't spend enough time on those important activities.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Analyse your diary and divide your activities into different categories to see where you are spending your time. E.g. for customer-facing roles, how much time are you spending with the customer, versus internal activities? Are you spending enough time on the important tasks and are your work priorities aligned with the team's goals?

Procrastination

Sometimes, we put off difficult tasks because they appear daunting, or we delay making significant decisions because we are uncertain as to the best course of action. As a result, we do nothing, which often makes the situation more critical, causing additional stress and impacting our self-confidence further. Fear of failure and concern related to what others might think of our practice are often the key drivers in this instance.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

When starting a new task which appears large and complex, begin by breaking it down into more manageable chunks. Take a step back and consider what is holding you back from moving forward or from making a decision. Ask yourself what the real cause of your obstruction might be. Question your doubts and consider the likelihood of them happening, before you let them negatively impact your actions. Consider how you plan to mitigate failure and what support is available to aid you in your decision-making.

Self-Efficacy

Linked to self-confidence and self-esteem, self-efficacy refers to your belief in your ability to accomplish specific tasks. People with low self-efficacy often suffer from 'imposter syndrome,' where they feel that they are not competent enough to succeed in a role or specific activity. Their immediate thought when asked to do something is, 'I can't do this.' It is often a fear of failure that holds people back.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Separate feelings from facts; you often know more than you credit yourself with and you can learn new skills. Remind yourself of previous successes, focus on your strengths and talents, stop comparing yourself with others and talk to other people about your concerns, the chances are that they have the same thoughts and feelings from time to time.

Keeping Things in Perspective

In situations which involve high pressure, it is not unusual for people to overreact to minor issues. If high pressure is sustained, these reactions can become the norm and this results in us constantly operating in crisis mode, appearing to others that we are always operating in that way. In these situations it is important to take a step back and keep things in perspective.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

A simple approach is to rank each issue in a typical week on a stress scale of 1 to 10; 10 being the highest level of stress. Regular issues which occur day-to-day should usually only be ranked up to a 3. However, with our constantly busy work and home lives, we are often operating at a level of 5 or 6 on a regular basis, which means that any setback can easily take us up to an 8 or 9. Take a step back and before reacting, ask yourself, what level of reaction is appropriate.

Focus on What is in Your Control

Throughout our lives, many things happen that are outside of our immediate control. This can cause us to worry about the potential impact these things may have and the more we focus on this, the more negative we become. As we become more negative, we lose motivation and start looking for people to blame. We can fall into the 'victim trap.'

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

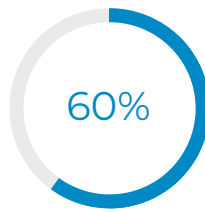
Focus on the areas that you can influence and put all of your energy into finding solutions and ways to make a greater impact. Simply create two columns and list the things that you can't influence in column 'A' and the things that you can influence in column 'B.' Now focus your energy into the areas you can influence in column 'B' and learn to live with the items in column 'A.'

Self-Confidence

Self-confident people trust their judgement and abilities and value themselves, regardless of any weaknesses they may have or what others may think of them. As a result, self-confident people tend to take more risks and are not put off by failure, using setbacks as learning experiences for the future.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Building self-confidence isn't easy, but here are some starting points: Understanding your skills and abilities and writing them down can help you build your self-confidence. List the things that you have done well and are proud of. Stepping out of your comfort zone is another good way of building your confidence e.g. speaking up in meetings or volunteering to do a task.



Purpose

In the area of Purpose, your level of resilience is 60%. Having a clear sense of purpose and defined goals – in our personal lives and at work – is a key factor when it comes to building resilience. Knowing what we are trying to achieve helps us to bounce back and stay on course following setbacks, enabling us to remain true to ourselves and our values.

The outcome of the assessment tool indicates that you may benefit from focusing on the following areas:



Defining a Clear Purpose or Direction in Your Life

A key aspect of developing resilience is having a clear purpose or meaning to your life. Having a clear vision of where we are headed and what we are trying to achieve helps us stay on course, even when obstacles are presented along the way. Having that sense of purpose enables us to get back up when we are knocked down and stay focused on our destination. Without this sense of purpose, many people find it hard to recover from setbacks and maintain forward momentum. Having a career plan is one example of a defined purpose which can help us maintain direction and overcome obstacles.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Defining a clear purpose or direction can take many forms, but one common factor is a clear understanding and visualisation of what success looks like. This could be in terms of your overall life e.g. 'I want to help others,' or 'I want to improve the world for future generations,' or it could be more specifically aligned, for example, to a career goal e.g. 'I want to be a VP level by the time I am 40.' Whatever your vision is, make it clear, tangible, measurable and achievable with a defined timeframe. Working with a coach can help you define your purpose and vision.

Identifying Clear Goals With Timelines and Actions

Having established your vision or purpose, it is important to break it down into clearly defined steps or milestones with actions and timelines to help you achieve success. Without this it will be very difficult to achieve your vision and you may become disheartened at the lack of progress.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Imagine you are on the bank of a river and on the opposite bank lies your destination – your vision or purpose. Spanning the river are 3 to 5 stepping stones. What are these 3 to 5 key steps/initiatives that you need to take in order to cross the river and reach the other side? Ask yourself what it would mean to reach the other side and how it would feel.

Leveraging Your Strengths

Traditional thinking emphasised the need to focus on improving our weaknesses rather than developing and leveraging our strengths. Leveraging our strengths and natural talents tends to make us happier, more energised and more positive, both at work and in the home environment.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Identify your key strengths and understand how you can best leverage them in your role. Do you spend time developing them further? Does your role allow you to leverage those strengths on a daily basis? Understand your weaknesses and identify ways of mitigating them through some level of personal development or through support from a colleague.

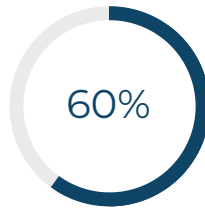
Understand Your Core Values

Our values are the principles which help us decide what is right and wrong, and how to act in specific situations. Values differ from person to person and when faced with a difficult situation, we have to decide where to draw the line when our values are challenged. Being 'true to yourself' is about living according to your values on a day-to-day basis and being authentic.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

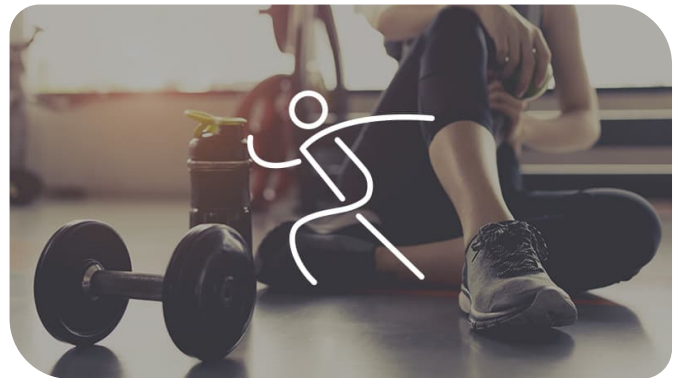
Identify your core values and understand how these govern your behaviour and decision making process. Think of a time in your life where your values were challenged. What happened, what did you do?



Physical Stamina

In the area of Physical Stamina, your level of resilience is 60%. Good exercise, nutrition and restorative sleep are critical to improving resilience. It doesn't require becoming an athlete, it simply requires being conscious of the components our body and mind need in order to support a positive lifestyle.

The outcome of the assessment tool indicates that you may benefit from focusing on the following areas:



Improving Nutrition

Having a well-balanced diet and eating at the right times is an important aspect of self-care and building physical endurance. For many people this may just mean small adjustments to what they eat and when, and avoiding binging, comfort eating and drinking alcohol when things get stressful.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Keep a diary of what you eat and drink during a typical week, and when, then assess any changes that you would like to make. Potentially seek advice and guidance from a professionally qualified nutritionist.

Taking Regular Exercise

Physical exercise is an excellent way of reducing stress and building confidence and self-esteem, when done regularly as part of a routine. You don't have to be a marathon runner or a top athlete to benefit from it, you just need to make time for it and prioritise it in your schedule.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Build up your exercise routine gradually and don't expect to get results immediately. When your body is getting used to physical activity again, stretching is important to ensure that you don't sustain injuries which may slow down or prevent your activity. Try a new sport, exercise with family or friends and find what works for you.

Improving Work/Life Balance

As demands at work increase, we often find ourselves working longer hours and weekends and we lose the time which we need to relax and recharge. This often leads to burnout and is hard to reverse unless a conscious effort is made to reduce the amount of time spent working.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Take a step back and evaluate what is causing the additional workload. Is it something you can control through better prioritisation, reduced need for perfection, faster decision-making or delegation? Or is the increased workload due to lack of resources, perhaps a skill or capability. Discuss it with your manager and come up with a plan to get your work/life balance back under control.

Improving Quality and Length of Sleep

During periods of stress, change in the quality of our sleep is commonplace. Waking up regularly and not being able to get back to sleep make us feel drained before we face the day ahead. Sleep is vital to repair and rejuvenate our bodies and minds and to keep them functioning effectively. A good night's sleep can significantly increase concentration, energy levels, motivation and performance. Conversely, sleep deprivation can negatively impact performance, with increased irritability, lack of energy and lower motivation.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Developing a sleep routine by going to bed and getting up at the same time will help set you up for a good night's sleep. Avoid screen-time, eating and drinking caffeine before bed, as these are all stimulants which will keep you awake. Regular exercise is a way of ensuring that you are physically tired and is likely to lead to better sleep. Eating earlier in the evening also gives you a better chance of a good night's sleep, allowing adequate time for digestion.

Separating Work and Home

In today's busy world and changing work environment, the separation between work and home has become increasingly blurred. It is important to consider how often you are checking your emails and responding to messages from colleagues in your free time. With many of us working from home on a part-time or full-time basis, it's easy to find ourselves without any separation from the work environment.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Make a conscious effort to 'finish' work at the end of the day and leave your laptop/phone in your home office or somewhere out of sight. Whilst at home, ensure that you only work in your home office or a dedicated working space, where possible. When you have finished at the end of the day, make sure that you leave work behind you. There may be occasions where this isn't possible, but try it for an extended period and see how it feels.

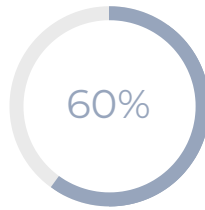
Taking Time to Relax and Recharge

One of the most important aspects of becoming more resilient is learning how we can relax and recharge our batteries. A good night's sleep is important, but we also need to find ways of relaxing mentally and clearing our minds of concerns and issues which weigh on us.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Meditation, mindfulness and breathing exercises are all ways in which we can relax our bodies and minds. Relaxation primes us for any challenges that may arise in the future. These exercises do not require a lot of time to practice on a daily basis. Alternatively; short walks, reading and visiting the gym are all ways in which we can de-stress and get some breathing space.



Emotional Intelligence

In the area of Emotional Intelligence, your level of resilience is 60%. High levels of Emotional Intelligence (EQ) enable us to recognise and manage our emotions, as well as the emotions of others. Emotions drive our behaviour and understanding how to manage them is crucial, particularly when dealing with pressure and stressful situations.

The outcome of the assessment tool indicates that you may benefit from focusing on the following areas:



Self-Awareness

Resilient people typically have higher levels of self-awareness, a clear understanding of their strengths and weaknesses and a core set of personal values which help them navigate their lives. Leveraging and developing your strengths and talents, whilst mitigating your weaknesses, will enable you to find roles which suit you, making you happier and more positive in the process.



RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Write down your top 5 strengths and weaknesses. How do you leverage your strengths and talents in the current role you are performing at work? Are you investing in developing them further? What are you doing to mitigate your weaknesses?

Managing Emotions

Emotions drive our behaviour and can impact people positively and negatively. Understanding how to manage emotions is critical, particularly when under pressure in stressful situations. In highly stressful situations, we can sometimes trigger a 'fight or flight' response, whereby the amygdala in our brain responds to threats in our environment by shutting off the logical decision-making part of our brain. This automatic emotional response can manifest itself as uncontrollable outbursts, which often escalate things further.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Having a better understanding of the things in your day-to-day which trigger high levels of stress, will enable you to recognise warning signs before your stress levels increase, allowing you to potentially mitigate any emotional reaction. Taking some time before responding to a trigger will allow the amygdala-based, emotional reaction to reduce, enabling the logical part of the brain to take over. Keeping calm under pressure and controlling emotions is an important factor for leaders, as their teams react based on how they respond in challenging situations.

Self-Esteem

Self-esteem is defined as how we view ourselves in terms of our personal worth or value. People with higher levels of self-esteem tend to feel positive about themselves and life in general. In turn, this helps them cope with adversity and recover from difficult situations. People with lower self-esteem tend to have a more negative view of themselves, a more negative outlook on their lives and can be very self-critical.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

List your strengths and talents and write down past successes and accolades. Become aware of the negative thoughts that are impacting your self-worth and challenge these thoughts by thinking of more realistic and positive outcomes. Practice self-compassion by forgiving yourself for past mistakes and weaknesses and look forwards not backwards.

Stress Triggers

When we feel that we are being personally attacked, our relationships are being challenged, or our principles are being impacted, we tend to react in an emotional way. Understanding our personal triggers, enables us to recognise them as a situation develops and respond in a more measured way.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Reflect on a situation in which you reacted negatively because you felt threatened in some way. What was the trigger that caused you to react in an emotional way? How did you feel at the time and how did you feel afterwards? In many situations, we may feel that our reaction was justified at the time, but on further reflection, we may feel that our response could have been less emotional.

Managing Conflict

From time to time we may encounter conflict in a work or personal environment, perhaps where differences of opinion occur. It is important to resolve the issue early on to avoid an escalation of the situation and a potential breakdown in communication and relationships. When conflict remains unresolved, it can consume large amounts of emotional energy, affect our ability to focus – reducing our productivity – and it often impacts a wider group of people.

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

Consider what the cause of the conflict is. View the issue from both perspectives and be open and honest in the feedback you give, without making it personal. Ideally, look to have the discussion with the person immediately after the situation has occurred rather than waiting. Have the discussion privately, taking a collaborative approach to resolving the situation, for example, 'what can we do to resolve this issue together?'

Feedback

Giving and receiving feedback is an important element of building trusting relationships with other people. Feedback is a gift for the person receiving it. It tells them something about themselves that perhaps they were unaware of and could help them develop moving forward. We need to be comfortable giving feedback – positive and negative – and have the courage to do so, even if we feel uncomfortable. We need to actively seek feedback from others to understand how we are perceived, which may differ from how we perceive ourselves.

*"We all need people who will give us feedback.
That's how we improve."*

- Bill Gates

RESILIENCEBUILDER TIP

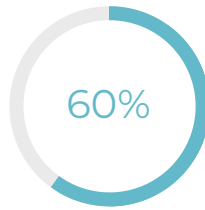
The most simple and powerful form of positive feedback is thanking someone for a job well done. It has a positive impact on the mood of the individual receiving it and is best delivered without delay. Giving candid feedback to others can be challenging for some, but it's important to give feedback in the moment and in a constructive rather than a negative or personal way. Avoid the temptation to become defensive when receiving feedback.

Asking for Help

For many of us, asking for help may be seen as exposing a weakness to another team member or manager. We tend to avoid it, preferring instead to continue to be independent and self-sufficient. In an environment where we have trusting relationships and psychological safety, asking for help from our network gives us the emotional support we need to recover from adverse situations and is a key element of building resilience.

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Think about the last time you asked for help. What was the situation? How did you feel? What was the reaction of the person you asked? Do you have people you can confide in?



Social Support

In the area of Social Support, your level of resilience is 60%. Having a strong social support network of family, friends and colleagues is an essential aspect of resilience. When things get tough, having people you can confide in and turn to for support is vital, as is having a mentor to help you navigate through your journey.

The outcome of the assessment tool indicates that you may benefit from focusing on the following areas:



An Established Support Network

A key aspect of resilience is our ability to develop strong relationships both at work and at home. It is important to have people we can turn to for help, support and guidance. Building positive relationships where there may have been past challenges or issues is also critical.

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Identify the key relationships in your life, in terms of family and friends and also colleagues. Assess the strength of your relationship with each person in your network, and what these relationships provide for you. Identify the relationships you wish to develop further along with any gaps in your support network.

Identifying People You Can Trust and Confide In

An important stage of developing your support network is to identify people you can confide in. This can be outside of work or within the work environment. Knowing who to turn to for specific support is critical. The knowledge that you have a support network in place to help you through difficult and challenging situations will help you to build resilience.



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Look at your support network of family, friends and colleagues and identify who you might turn to in specific situations. You may feel more comfortable seeking advice from a close friend when there is a family or relationship issue. At work, you may find it beneficial to seek advice from a colleague with an objective standpoint e.g. someone who doesn't work directly in your team or under the same manager as you.

Identifying a Mentor or Coach

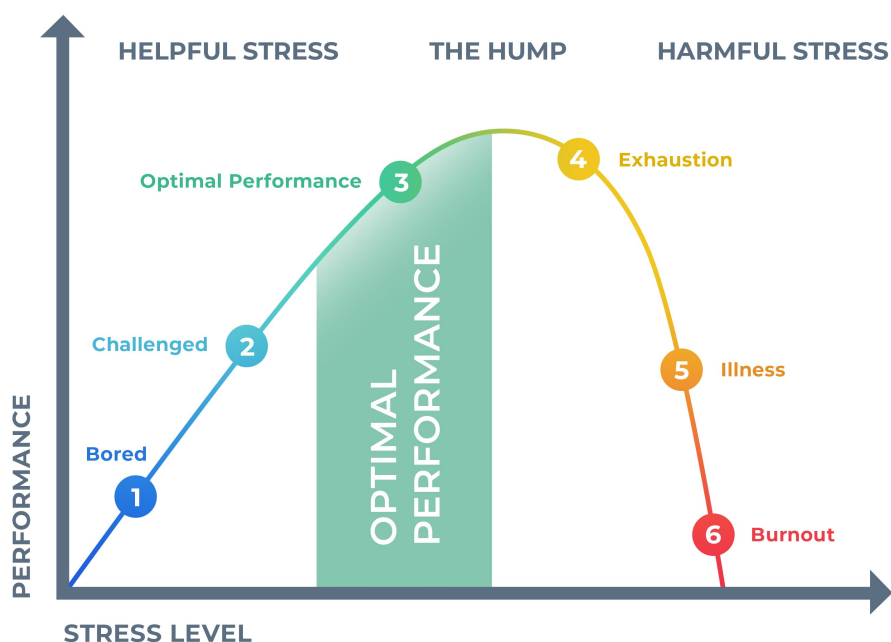
Having a mentor or coach who can help you navigate through life's up and downs can be a very important aspect of providing emotional support and balance. A mentoring relationship tends to focus on providing advice and guidance, based on the experience of the mentor. A coaching relationship focuses on assisting you in finding answers, based on a vision or goal, and should help you in building a plan, holding you to account along the way.



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Start by considering what your current needs are and decide whether you would benefit from a mentor, who can provide you with advice and guidance in specific areas, or a coach, who can help you identify the steps you need to take to realise your full potential. Many organisations offer a mentor programme and some offer professional coaching, exploring the support available is a good place to start.

The Stress v Performance Curve



Navigating the Curve

The stress/performance curve above illustrates the relationship between performance (vertical scale) and stress (horizontal scale). A certain level of pressure is needed to reach the 'sweet spot' of optimal performance, but prolonged pressure may lead to exhaustion.

Remaining in the exhaustion phase over a long period of time causes performance to decline, and without the chance to reset, this can lead to illness or even burnout. Illness is characterised by short periods of absence from work, whilst burnout is usually associated with extended periods of absence..

On the left side of the curve, you may feel 'bored' if the role doesn't test your capabilities. The 'challenged' phase can apply to those struggling to reach optimal performance, perhaps due to being new, unclear roles or priorities, or team conflict.

Where Are You on The Curve?



You assessed yourself as being in the 'exhaustion' stage.

Think about how long you have felt this way and what are the likely causes. Is your workload too high causing you to regularly work in the evenings and weekends? Are you sacrificing other aspects of your life such as exercise, eating healthily, socialising or relaxing. Make adjustments to your routine and seek support from your manager to address some of the root causes in the workplace. By making the changes now, you can avoid moving to the illness phase.

Stress Management Indicator (SMI) - Results

How Effective are you at Managing Stress?



Based on the answers you gave in the Assessment, your Stress Management Indicator (SMI) suggests that you are **Less Effective** at managing stress.

What to Focus On:

- **Build Awareness:** Reflect on what causes you stress at work and home. In the workplace the most common sources of anxiety and stress are outlined below. Ask yourself:

Is my role clearly defined? Do I have measurable goals? Is my workload manageable? Is there conflict within the team? Am I being treated fairly? Do I have the support I need from my manager and the team?

If you're struggling with any of these areas, initiate a conversation with your manager or a trusted person to explore solutions.

- **Prioritise Self-care:** Look after yourself by eating healthily and exercising regularly and set boundaries between work and home to give you the time and space to spend time with family, friends and for yourself.
- **Strengthen Core Practices:** Identify one or two habits (e.g., time management, prioritisation, conflict management, regular exercise or healthy sleep routines) to further support your approach to stress management.
- **Seek Support:** Don't hesitate to reach out to trusted friends, family, or a coach or mentor for guidance and encouragement. If you are feeling overwhelmed, you may also wish to seek professional help and support.
- **Be Kind to Yourself:** Focus on progress rather than perfection and celebrate small wins along the way.

Managing Stress

Our ability to manage stress is a key factor when building and sustaining resilience. Resilient individuals tend to bounce back from stressful situations more quickly, with less negative impact on their mental and physical wellbeing.

Managing stress is highly correlated with resilience. Our own research using the ResilienceBuilder Assessment Tool shows that 94% of people with high levels of resilience (Strong) were 'highly effective/effective' at managing stress.

Effective stress management involves recognising the triggers that cause stress, developing healthy coping strategies, and maintaining a balanced perspective when difficulties arise.



Techniques such as mindfulness, active problem-solving, and social support are vital tools in reducing the intensity of stress responses, thereby preventing burnout and anxiety. These methods help build resilience by promoting emotional regulation, enhancing problem-solving skills, and reinforcing a sense of control over one's environment.

In turn, resilience supports stress management by empowering individuals to approach stress with confidence, optimism, and adaptability. Resilient individuals are more likely to view stress as a manageable challenge rather than an insurmountable obstacle, which reduces their overall stress levels and enables them to recover more effectively from setbacks.



Recommended Areas for Managing Stress

Outlined below are 5 priority sub-facet areas to work on to help you manage stress and build your resilience. Check to see if these recommendations appear in the main body of the report.



Relax and Recharge - Mindfulness and Meditation

Mindfulness practices such as meditation and breathing exercises, yoga and walks in nature are highly effective in reducing stress and enhancing resilience.



Social Support

Strong support networks of family, friends and colleagues are crucial for building resilience. Social connections provide emotional support, encouragement and practical help during difficult times.



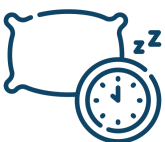
Physical Exercise

Regular physical exercise is a powerful stress reliever that boosts resilience. Exercise reduces the body's stress hormones, such as cortisol, and stimulates the production of endorphins which improve mood.



Positivity - Reframing Negative thoughts

Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT) helps individuals manage stress by changing negative thought patterns and behaviours. Reframing negative thoughts helps us interpret stressful situations more positively, reducing the perception of stress and enhancing resilience.



Quality Sleep

Quality sleep is essential for managing stress and building resilience. Chronic stress often disrupts sleep, leading to a vicious cycle that exacerbates both stress and health problems. Quality sleep helps improve emotional regulation, cognitive function and stress recovery.

Your Personal Resilience Development Plan

Take time to review your Assessment Report in detail, read through the information and advice carefully then select two focus areas which you would like to prioritise. Fill in the development plan below to outline your plan of action; making your next steps concrete is crucial to getting meaningful change underway.

Development Area 1

Facet (e.g. Mental Strength)

Focus Area (e.g. Prioritisation)

Describe the challenges you face

What impact does this have on you?

Action: What are you going to do differently going forward?

What help will you need?

How will you measure success?

How will you make sure that it becomes a habit?

How will this positively impact you?

Development Area 2

Facet (e.g. Mental Strength)

Focus Area (e.g. Prioritisation)

Describe the challenges you face

What impact does this have on you?

Action: What are you going to do differently going forward?

What help will you need?

How will you measure success?

How will you make sure that it becomes a habit?

How will this positively impact you?



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